

EXPERIMENT 3: QUALYS CLOUD AGENT DEPLOYMENT IN WINDOWS

1. Aim

To install the Qualys Cloud Agent on a Windows machine, register it with the Qualys Cloud Platform using an activation key and verify that the host reports to the platform.

2. Introduction

The Qualys Cloud Agent is a lightweight program installed on a host. It collects asset inventory and vulnerability data and sends it securely to the Qualys Cloud Platform over HTTPS, so the host does not need to be scanned across the network. It is useful for laptops and remote machines that are not always on the corporate network.

3. Requirements

- Windows machine with administrator rights
- Qualys subscription with the Cloud Agent module enabled
- Outbound HTTPS (port 443) access to the Qualys platform URL
- Activation key, Customer ID and platform URL from the Qualys portal

4. Procedure

- Log in to Qualys and open the **Cloud Agent** module.
- Go to **Activation Keys > New Key**, give the key a title, set the limit on the number of agents if required and click Generate. Copy the Activation ID and the Customer ID.
- Open **Agent Management > Install Agents** and download the Windows installer (QualysCloudAgent.exe). The page also shows the WebServiceUri for your platform.
- Copy the installer to the Windows host. Open Command Prompt as Administrator and run the command below.
- Wait for the installation to complete. The agent starts automatically and performs its first scan.
- Verify the installation as described in the output section.

```
QualysCloudAgent.exe CustomerId=YOUR_CUSTOMER_ID  
ActivationId=YOUR_ACTIVATION_ID  
WebServiceUri=https://qagpublic.qg1.apps.qualys.com/CloudAgent/
```

The command above is typed on a single line. The WebServiceUri differs for each Qualys platform, so use the value shown in your own portal. The installer can also be run by double-clicking and entering the IDs in the wizard.

5. Output

Figure 1: Cloud Agent architecture



Agent sends data outbound only; no inbound connection to the host is needed

Figure 2: Deployment workflow

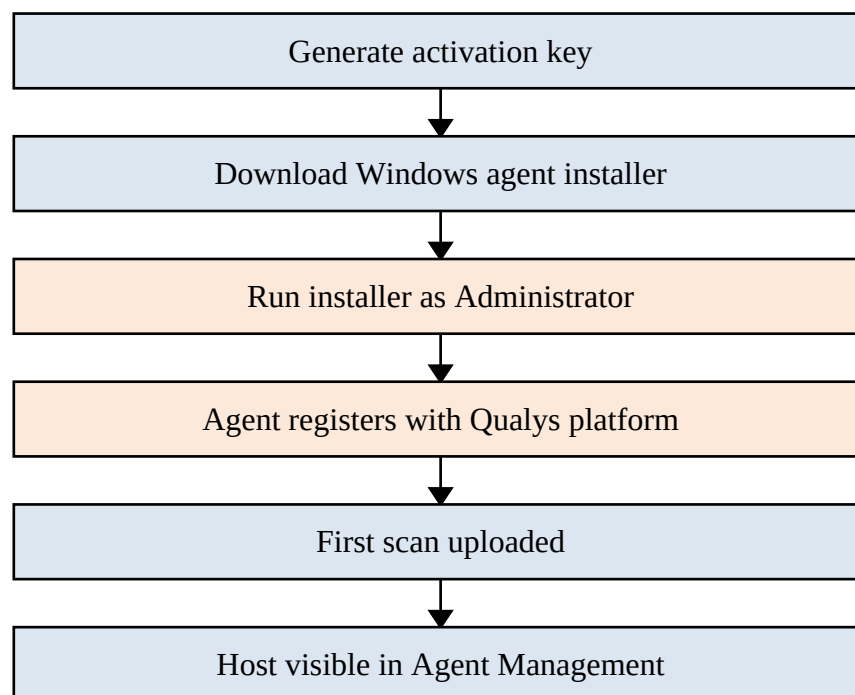


Figure 3: Verification checks (illustrative)

Check	Where to look	Expected result
Agent service	services.msc: Qualys Cloud Agent	Status: Running
Local logs	C:\ProgramData\Qualys\QualysAgent	Log files updating without errors
Portal status	Cloud Agent > Agent Management	Host listed with status Active / Connected
Assets	Assets / Cloud Agent tab	Host appears with OS and installed software

Note: The figures show the expected structure of the output. Exact names, values and screens may differ in your own environment and software version.

6. Result

The Qualys Cloud Agent was installed on the Windows host using an activation key, and the host was confirmed in the Qualys Cloud Agent module.